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Image forming apparatus that performs handover, method of controlling the same, and storage medium

Abstract

The present image forming apparatus selects an appropriate connection method in accordance with circumstances from a plurality of connection methods when communication with an information processing apparatus is established by short-range wireless communication, and notifies information necessary for performing communication by the selected connection method to the information processing apparatus via short-range wireless communication.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

Field of the Invention

(1) The present invention relates to a communication image forming apparatus comprising a short-range wireless communication function, a method of controlling the same, and a storage medium.

Description of the Related Art

(2) In recent years, NFC (Near Field Communication), which is one type of short-range wireless communication (non-contact communication) is spreading in various fields. NFC has a very short communication range; when devices that perform communication approach within a few cm of each other, a wireless link is connected, and the wireless link is disconnected when they move apart. In this way, for devices in which NFC is installed, it is possible to perform communication by causing them to approach each other. For this reason, NFC can provide a convenient method for a user to simply use various services, and is attracting attention and being put to practical use in various fields.

(3) As a technique in which NFC is used, there is a technique in which communication is performed by just performing pairing between information processing apparatuses by NFC, and subsequently switching (performing a handover) to another connection method (BlueTooth (registered trademark), WiFi-Direct, a wireless LAN). As a usage approach for such a handover, a method in which, in order for a user holding a mobile communication terminal to perform communication with an MFP (Multi-Function Printer) in front of the user, pairing between the mobile communication terminal and the MFP is performed by NFC, and then communication is performed via a wireless LAN is known.

(4) However, a case in which the MFP detected by NFC cannot communicate with the mobile communication terminal by the wireless LAN for a reason of not being connected to a network or the like can be considered. Japanese Patent Laid-Open No. 2013-187568 proposes that a mobile communication terminal list MFPs that can communicate by a wireless LAN, and if there is an MFP detected by NFC in the list, perform communication with the MFP via the wireless LAN, and if there is no MFP detected by NFC in the list, perform control to not perform a handover.

(5) However, there is a problem with the above described conventional technique as recited below. In the above described conventional technique, when the MFP and the mobile communication terminal perform a handover, the MFP uses one connection method that it supports as the connection method to hand over communication from NFC to. However, there exist circumstances in which connection methods cannot be used in communication with the mobile communication terminal. For example, a wireless LAN cannot be used when the mobile communication terminal does not have authorization to access a network that the MFP is connected to. Accordingly, a method that selects a connection method to which to hand over communication by the handover so as to be able to use a connection method suited to the circumstances is required.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(6) The present invention enables realization of an arrangement of suitably selecting a connection method that switches from short-range wireless communication in accordance with circumstances of a connecting apparatus.

(7) One aspect of the present invention provides an image forming apparatus, comprising: a short-range wireless communication unit configured to execute short-range wireless communication; a wireless communication unit operable in a first wireless communication mode in which the image forming apparatus connects to an external access point, and a second wireless communication mode in which the image forming apparatus operates as an access point; a setting unit configured to set whether to write first connection information corresponding to the first wireless communication mode or second connection information corresponding to the second wireless communication mode to the short-range wireless communication unit in accordance with a user instruction; and a writing unit configured to write one of the first connection information and the second connection information to the short-range wireless communication unit in accordance with the setting by the setting unit.

(8) Another aspect of the present invention provides an image forming apparatus, comprising: a short-range wireless communication unit configured to execute short-range wireless communication; a wireless communication unit operable in a first wireless communication mode in which the image forming apparatus connects to an external access point, and a second wireless communication mode in which the image forming apparatus operates as an access point; a selection unit configured to select either first connection information corresponding to the first wireless communication mode or second connection information corresponding to the second wireless communication mode based on user information of a user that uses the image forming apparatus; and a writing unit configured to write the connection information selected by the selection unit to the short-range wireless communication unit.

(9) Still another aspect of the present invention provides a method for controlling an image forming apparatus comprising a short-range wireless communication unit configured to execute short-range wireless communication and a wireless communication unit operable in a first wireless communication mode in which the image forming apparatus connects to an external access point and a second wireless communication mode in which the image forming apparatus operates as an access point, the method comprising: setting whether to write first connection information corresponding to the first wireless communication mode or second connection information corresponding to the second wireless communication mode to the short-range wireless communication unit in accordance with a user instruction; and writing one of the first connection information and the second connection information to the short-range wireless communication unit

in accordance with the setting.

(10) Yet still another aspect of the present invention provides a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium storing a computer program for causing a computer to execute a method for controlling an image forming apparatus comprising a short-range wireless communication unit configured to execute short-range wireless communication and a wireless communication unit operable in a first wireless communication mode in which the image forming apparatus connects to an external access point and a second wireless communication mode in which the image forming apparatus operates as an access point, the method comprising: setting whether to write first connection information corresponding to the first wireless communication mode or second connection information corresponding to the second wireless communication mode to the short-range wireless communication unit in accordance with a user instruction; and writing one of the first connection information and the second connection information to the short-range wireless communication unit in accordance with the setting.

(11) Still yet another aspect of the present invention provides a method for controlling an image forming apparatus comprising a short-range wireless communication unit configured to execute short-range wireless communication and a wireless communication unit operable in a first wireless communication mode in which the image forming apparatus connects to an external access point and a second wireless communication mode in which the image forming apparatus operates as an access point, the method comprising: selecting either first connection information corresponding to the first wireless communication mode or second connection information corresponding to the second wireless communication mode based on user information of a user that uses the image forming apparatus; and writing the selected connection information to the short-range wireless communication unit.

(12) Yet still another aspect of the present invention provides a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium storing a computer program for causing a computer to execute a method for controlling an image forming apparatus comprising a short-range wireless communication unit configured to execute short-range wireless communication and a wireless communication unit operable in a first wireless communication mode in which the image forming apparatus connects to an external access point and a second wireless communication mode in which the image forming apparatus operates as an access point, the method comprising: selecting either first connection information corresponding to the first wireless communication mode or second connection information corresponding to the second wireless communication mode based on user information of a user that uses the image forming apparatus; and writing the selected connection information to the short-range wireless communication unit.

(13) Further features of the present invention will be apparent from the following description of exemplary embodiments with reference to the attached drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a schematic view that illustrates a communication system **100** according to a first embodiment.

(2) FIG. 2 is a block diagram for illustrating a hardware configuration of an information processing apparatus **130** according to the first embodiment.

(3) FIG. 3 is a block diagram for illustrating a hardware configuration of an image forming apparatus **140** according to the first embodiment.

(4) FIG. 4 is a block diagram for illustrating a software configuration of the communication system **100** according to the first embodiment.

(5) FIG. 5 is a view for illustrating an example of a screen for setting a connection method used by

a handover according to the first embodiment.

(6) FIG. 6 is a flowchart that illustrates processing of a connection method setting unit **413** of the image forming apparatus **140** according to the first embodiment.

(7) FIG. 7 is a flowchart illustrating processing concerning a communication handover in a handover of an NFC communication unit **213** of the information processing apparatus **130** according to the first embodiment.

(8) FIG. 8 is a block diagram for illustrating a software configuration of the communication system **100** according to a second embodiment.

(9) FIG. 9 is a view for illustrating an example of management information held by a user information management unit **813** according to the second embodiment.

(10) FIG. 10 is a flowchart that illustrates processing of the user information management unit **813** of the image forming apparatus **140** according to the second embodiment.

(11) FIG. 11 is a block diagram for illustrating a software configuration of the communication system **100** according to a third embodiment.

(12) FIG. 12 is a flowchart that illustrates processing of an NFC control unit **1112** of the image forming apparatus **140** according to the third embodiment.

(13) FIG. 13 is a schematic view that illustrates the communication system according to a fourth embodiment.

(14) FIG. 14 is a block diagram for illustrating a software configuration of the communication system **100** according to the fourth embodiment.

(15) FIG. 15 is a flowchart that illustrates processing of an NFC control unit **1412** of the image forming apparatus **140** according to the fourth embodiment.

(16) FIG. 16 is a block diagram for illustrating a software configuration of the communication system **100** according to a fifth embodiment.

(17) FIG. 17 is a flowchart that illustrates processing of an NFC control unit **1612** of the image forming apparatus **140** according to the fifth embodiment.

(18) FIG. 18 is a schematic view illustrating a communication system **1800** when the image forming apparatus **140** is connected to a network **110** by wire.

(19) FIG. 19 is a view for illustrating an example of a setting screen of a connection method used by a handover in FIG. 18.

DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

(20) Embodiments of the present invention will now be described in detail with reference to the drawings. It should be noted that the relative arrangement of the components, the numerical expressions and numerical values set forth in these embodiments do not limit the scope of the present invention unless it is specifically stated otherwise.

First Embodiment

(21) <System Configuration>

(22) Below, with reference to FIG. 1 through FIG. 7, FIG. 18 and FIG. 19, explanation is given for a first embodiment of the present invention. Firstly, referring to FIG. 1, explanation is given for a configuration of a communication system according to the present embodiment.

(23) Reference numeral **100** in the drawing is a communication system, which is comprised of a network **110**, an access point **120**, an information processing apparatus **130**, and an image forming apparatus **140**. In the present embodiment, the information processing apparatus **130** is envisioned to be a mobile communication terminal such as a smart phone. In the present embodiment, the image forming apparatus **140** is envisioned to be an MFP (Multi-Function Printer), and is connected to the network **110** via the access point **120**. Note that, the present invention is not limited to the configuration in the figure in regards to the system configuration of a number or the like of the information processing apparatus, image forming apparatus or the access point, and may be appropriately changed in a scope in which the spirit of the present invention is not impaired. In addition, the information processing apparatus **130** and the image forming apparatus **140** can

perform short-range wireless communication with each other, and this communication is established when the information processing apparatus **130** is positioned in the neighborhood of the image forming apparatus **140**.

(24) <Information Processing Apparatus Hardware Configuration>

(25) Next, FIG. 2 will give an explanation for a hardware configuration of the information processing apparatus **130** according to the first embodiment. Note that the configuration of the information processing apparatus **130** explained below is only one example, and changes may be made as appropriate in a scope in which the spirit of the present invention is not impaired.

(26) The information processing apparatus **130** comprises a system control unit **201**, a communication unit **202**, an audio output unit **203**, an audio input unit **204**, a camera **205**, a connector **206**, and a storage **207**. Furthermore, the information processing apparatus **130** comprises a touch screen display **208**, buttons **209**, an accelerometer **210**, a direction sensor **211**, a gyroscope **212**, and an NFC communication unit **213**.

(27) The touch screen display **208** displays text, images, and graphics such as diagrams, and detects a user operation (a tap, flick or the like by a finger or a stylus pen) performed with respect to the screen. The buttons **209** comprises a plurality of buttons that are operated by a user. The system control unit **201** detects operations (a click, a double-click, a push, or the like) on buttons by cooperating with the buttons **209**. For example, for buttons, there is a home button, a power ON/OFF button, a volume button, or the like.

(28) The communication unit **202** is a module that performs communication. A communication scheme performed by the communication unit **202** is in accordance with a wireless communication standard. For example, as wireless communication standards, there are 2G, 3G, or 4G mobile wireless communication standards. Bluetooth, WiFi (IEEE 802.11), WiMAX, or the like, are other wireless communication standards. The communication unit **202** can support a connection method of one or more of the above-described communication standards. In the present embodiment, the communication unit **202** supports a mobile wireless communication standard and WiFi.

(29) The NFC communication unit **213** generates an electromagnetic field that is capable of communication only at a short distance, and allows short-range wireless communication between devices equipped with NFC (Near Field Communication). In the present embodiment, this is an IC tag that supports NFC. The audio output unit **203** outputs an audio signal transmitted from the system control unit **201** as audio. The audio input unit **204** converts audio of a user into an audio signal, and transmits it to the system control unit **201**.

(30) The storage **207** stores a program and data.

(31) For example, it stores a control program, an application, and setting data. The storage **207** is also used as a work area that temporarily stores a result of processing of the system control unit **201**. The storage **207** may include a storage device such as a semiconductor storage device or a magnetic storage device. The storage **207** may also include a plurality of types of storage devices. The storage **207** may also combine a portable storage medium, such as a memory card, and an apparatus for reading the storage medium. Programs stored in the storage **207** include an application executed in a foreground or a background, and a control program that supports an operation of an application. For example, applications cause predetermined screens to be displayed on the touch screen display **208**, and cause processing to be executed by the system control unit **201** in accordance with user operations detected by the touch screen display **208**.

(32) The control program is, for example, an OS. The applications and the control program are installed on the storage **207** via wireless communication by the communication unit **202**. The control program provides functions relating to various control for causing the information processing apparatus **130** to operate. For example, the control program realizes making a call by controlling the communication unit **202**, the audio output unit **203**, the audio input unit **204**, or the like.

(33) The system control unit **201** is, for example, a CPU (Central Processing Unit). The system

control unit **201** may be an integrated circuit such as an SoC (System-on-a-chip) in which other components, such as the communication unit **202**, are integrated. The system control unit **201** comprehensively controls operation of the information processing apparatus **130**, and realizes various functions. More specifically, the system control unit **201** executes an instruction included in a program stored on the storage **207**, while referring to data stored on the storage **207** as necessary. The system control unit **201** realizes the various functions by controlling the touch screen display **208**, the communication unit **202**, or the like. The system control unit **201** may change control in accordance with a result of detection of various detection units such as the touch screen display **208**, the buttons **209**, the accelerometer **210**, or the like. The system control unit **201** performs reading/writing with respect to the NFC communication unit **213**.

(34) The camera **205** is an out-camera that captures an object. The connector **206** is a terminal to which another apparatus is connected. The connector **206** may be a general-purpose terminal, such as a USB (Universal Serial Bus), HDMI (registered trademark) (High-Definition Multimedia Interface), Light Peak (Thunderbolt), or an earphone/microphone connector. The connector **206** may be an exclusively designed terminal, such as a dock connector. Apparatuses that are connected to the connector **206** for example include an external storage, a speaker, and a communication apparatus.

(35) The accelerometer **210** detects a direction and a magnitude of an acceleration that acts on the information processing apparatus **130**. The direction sensor **211** detects an orientation of geomagnetism. The gyroscope **212** detects a rotation of the information processing apparatus **130**. Results of detection of the accelerometer **210**, the direction sensor **211**, and the gyroscope **212** are used in combination to detect a change in position and orientation of the information processing apparatus **130**.

(36) <Image Forming Apparatus Hardware Configuration>

(37) Next, with reference to FIG. 3, explanation is given for a hardware configuration of the image forming apparatus **140** according to the present embodiment. Note that the configuration of the image forming apparatus **140** explained below is only one example, and changes may be made as appropriate in a scope in which the spirit of the present invention is not impaired.

(38) The image forming apparatus **140** comprises a system control unit **301**, a ROM **302**, a RAM **303**, a scanner **304**, an operation unit **305**, a display unit **306**, and a communication control unit **307**. Furthermore, the image forming apparatus **140** comprises an external memory controller **308**, an external storage apparatus **309**, an NFC communication unit **310**, a print control unit **311**, and a system bus **312**.

(39) The system control unit **301** is a processing apparatus, such as a CPU, and has a function of executing various processes that the image forming apparatus **140** performs. The ROM **302** is a nonvolatile storage device, in which various control programs of the image forming apparatus **140** and initial setting values are stored. In the present embodiment, software that the image forming apparatus **140** has is stored on the ROM **302**, and as necessary is stored in the RAM **303** and then executed. The RAM **303** is a volatile storage device, and is used as a work area for the various processes that the image forming apparatus **140** performs. In the present embodiment, software that the image forming apparatus **140** has is stored in the RAM **303** and then executed.

(40) The scanner **304** is an image reading unit for reading an image printed on paper (a recording medium). In many cases, an automatic document feeder is attached to the scanner **304** as an option, and it is possible to automatically read a plurality of original pages. The operation unit **305** is an input apparatus such as a button, and the system control unit **301** continuously monitors its input state. The display unit **306** is a display apparatus such as an LED or an LCD, and performs display in accordance with control by the system control unit **301**.

(41) The communication control unit **307** is a connector for USB, a network, or the like, and a control apparatus therefor, and performs control of input and output with respect to an external unit in accordance with control from the system control unit **301**. In the present embodiment, the

communication control unit **307** supports USB communication and network communication, such as a wired/wireless LAN, WiFi-Direct (a standard in which a WiFi device itself can perform the role of an access point), or the like. The external memory controller **308** performs control of input and output or the like with respect to the external storage apparatus **309**, which is a hard disk or the like. The NFC communication unit **310** generates an electromagnetic field by which communication is possible at a short distance, and enables short-range wireless communication between devices that are NFC equipped. In the present embodiment, this is an RFID reader/writer. (42) The print control unit **311** comprises apparatuses for actually printing an image to a sheet, such as a fixing device system, a laser beam control system, and a paper conveyance system (not shown); a detection apparatus that detects printing success, an occurrence of an error, or the like; and a serial communication apparatus for communicating with the system control unit **301**. The system bus **312** is a bus to which the previously described system control unit **301**, ROM **302**, RAM **303**, scanner **304**, operation unit **305**, display unit **306**, communication control unit **307**, external memory controller **308**, NFC communication unit **310**, and the print control unit **311** are attached.

(43) <Software Configuration>

(44) Next, with reference to FIG. 4, explanation is given for a configuration of software of the communication system **100** according to the present embodiment. Note that the software configuration explained below is only one example, and changes may be made as appropriate in a scope in which the spirit of the present invention is not impaired.

(45) The information processing apparatus **130** has an application **400**. The application **400** is stored in the storage **207**, and is executed by the system control unit **201** as necessary. The application **400** is comprised by a communication control unit **401** and an NFC control unit **402**. The NFC control unit **402** uses the NFC communication unit **213** to perform communication with the NFC communication unit **310** of the image forming apparatus **140**. In the present embodiment, the NFC control unit **402** obtains information (hereinafter, referred to as connection information) necessary for switching communication by a handover by performing communication with the NFC communication unit **310**. The communication control unit **401** performs communication, via the communication unit **202**, with a communication control unit **411** of the image forming apparatus **140**, based on the connection information that the NFC control unit **402** obtained.

(46) The image forming apparatus **140** comprises the communication control unit **411**, a NFC control unit **412**, and a connection method setting unit **413**. The communication control unit **411** performs communication with the communication control unit **401** via the communication control unit **307**. The connection method setting unit **413** can set the connection method used in the handover in accordance with a user input. More specifically, when the user calls for setting of a connection method by the operation unit **305**, the connection method setting unit **413** causes a setting screen (FIG. 5) to be displayed on the display unit **306**, and the connection method designated by the user by the setting screen is stored in the RAM **303** as the connection method to be used in a handover.

(47) The NFC control unit **412** writes the connection method to be used in the handover and the connection information relating to the connection method to an IC tag of the NFC communication unit **310**. This is performed upon power supply activation of the image forming apparatus **140**, or when the connection method to be used in the handover is changed. The connection information written by the NFC control unit **412** is information necessary for the information processing apparatus **130** to switch communication in the handover. In the present embodiment, connection information for when WiFi-Direct is set is, for example, a name of an access point for WiFi-Direct that the communication control unit **307** comprises. In addition, the connection information for when wireless LAN is set is, for example, the name of the access point **120** that the image forming apparatus **140** uses, an IP address of the image forming apparatus **140**, or the like.

(48) Note that, according to the present invention, a data format for when the NFC control unit **412**

writes the connection method and the connection information to the IC tag may be any format to the extent that the spirit of the present invention is not impaired. For example, it may be a generic format such as NDEF (NFC Data Exchange Format), or it may be an independent format that is only accepted between the NFC control unit **402** and the NFC control unit **412**. In the present embodiment, an independent format that writes the connection method and the connection information to a particular address of the IC tag is used.

(49) <Setting Screen>

(50) Next, with reference to FIG. 5, explanation is given of a screen for setting the connection method used in the handover according to the present embodiment. A connection method setting screen **500** comprises an OK button **501**, a connection method check-box **502**, an AP setting check-box **503**, a connected AP display box **504**, and an AP input box **505**.

(51) The connection method check-box **502** displays on the display unit a UI for display control by which the user can select one connection method from usable connection methods. In the present embodiment, for the connection method check-box **502**, it is possible to select WiFi-Direct and a wireless LAN. In other words, the user can select one of WiFi-Direct and wireless LAN as the connection method.

(52) In the present embodiment, when WiFi-Direct of the image forming apparatus **140** cannot be used, the box for WiFi-Direct is displayed as grayed out and controlled to be unselectable, as illustrated by a connection method check-box **1902** of FIG. 19. Note that for FIG. 19, the image forming apparatus **140** illustrated in FIG. 18 does not have the wireless communication function, and illustrates a concrete example **1900** of the screen for setting the connection method in a communication system **1800** connected by wire to the network **110**. A detailed explanation of FIG. 18 and FIG. 19 is similar to FIG. 1 and FIG. 5, and thus is omitted.

(53) The AP setting check-boxes **503**, **504** are settable when wireless LAN is selected via the connection method check-box **502**, and provide a UI by which it is possible to select an AP setting method used upon a wireless LAN connection. Note that when the image forming apparatus **140** does not have AP information for connecting to the network **110**, only the item **504** in which a user manually inputs the AP information is selectable. In a case such as when the image forming apparatus **140** is connected to the access point **120**, and when the image forming apparatus **140** has AP information for connecting to the network **110**, the item **503**, which uses this information, is also selectable. When the image forming apparatus **140** has AP information for connecting to the network **110**, this information is displayed on the AP display box **505** for the AP to which the image forming apparatus **140** is connected. In the present embodiment, it is possible to select whether to use the AP information that the image forming apparatus **140** is using, or to use AP information that the user inputs manually.

(54) In the present embodiment, a case in which the image forming apparatus **140** does not have information of the access point **120**, as in the communication system **1800** illustrated in FIG. 18, is envisioned. In this case, as illustrated by an AP setting check-box **1903** and a connected AP display box **1905** of FIG. 19, the setting to use the connected AP is displayed as gray-out, and controlled to be unselectable. In the case in which the user has selected to input the AP information via the AP setting check-box **503**, the user inputs the AP information in the AP input box **505**. By pressing the OK button **501**, the user can instruct setting completion.

(55) <Processing of the Image Forming Apparatus>

(56) Next, with reference to FIG. 6, explanation is given for a processing procedure of the connection method setting unit **413** of the image forming apparatus **140** according to the present embodiment. This processing is started when a call for the setting screen of the connection method is instructed from the operation unit **305** of the image forming apparatus **140**. Note that the processing explained below is realized by the system control unit **301** reading a control program stored in the ROM **302** or the external storage apparatus **309** into the RAM **302** and executing it.

(57) In step **S601**, the connection method setting unit **413** refers to information that the

communication control unit **307** has, confirms a connection method that can be used in a communication handover in a handover, and the processing transitions to step **S602**. In the present embodiment, of the connection methods that the communication control unit **307** supports, wireless LAN and WiFi-Direct are usable connection methods. Continuing on, in step **S602**, the connection method setting unit **413** displays the previously described setting screen of FIG. 5 on the display unit **306**, and the processing transitions to step **S603**. In other words, here the connection methods that the communication control unit **307** supports are displayed on the setting screen as selectable. (58) In step **S603**, the connection method setting unit **413** determines whether the OK button **501**, which means setting finalization, has been pressed. If not pressed, the determination of step **S603** is repeated, and if pressed the processing transitions to step **S604**. In step **S604**, the connection method setting unit **413** stores in the RAM **303** the connection method input into the connection method setting screen **500** when the OK button **501** is pressed, as the connection method used in a handover. The processing then transitions to step **S605**. In step **S605**, the connection method setting unit **413** writes the connection method and the connection information to be used in a handover to the IC tag of the NFC communication unit **310**, and the processing terminates.

(59) <Processing of the Information Processing Apparatus>

(60) Next, with reference to FIG. 7, explanation is given for a processing procedure regarding communication handover in a handover of the NFC communication unit **213** of the information processing apparatus **130** according to the present embodiment. This processing is started when the NFC communication unit **213** of the information processing apparatus **130** and the NFC communication unit **310** of the image forming apparatus **140** approach each other, and communication according to NFC starts. Note that the processing explained below is realized by the system control unit **201** reading the control program stored in the storage **207** and executing it.

(61) In step **S701**, the application **400** performs reading of the IC tag of the NFC communication unit **310** via the NFC control unit **402**. When the reading completes, the processing transitions to step **S702**. In step **S702**, the application **400** determines whether the connection method and the connection information for switching communication via the handover are in the data that was read. If the connection method and the connection information are present, transition is made to step **S703**. If not present, the handover is not performed, and this processing terminates.

(62) In step **S703**, the application **400** determines whether the connection method read from the IC tag is a connection method supported by the communication unit **202**. If the connection method is supported, transition is made to step **S704**; if not the handover is not performed and this processing terminates. In step **S704**, based on the connection method and the connection information read from the IC tag, the application **400** starts communication with the image forming apparatus **140** via the communication control unit **401**, and switches communication from NFC to the connection method (executes the handover). In other words, here either a switch is made from NFC to communication in accordance with the wireless LAN or WiFi-Direct, or the processing terminates without switching the connection method from NFC. Subsequently this processing terminates.

(63) As explained above, because the image forming apparatus according to the present embodiment can set the connection method that the communication is switched to by the handover, the user can use a connection method suitable to circumstances of the communication system **100**.

Second Embodiment

(64) Below, with reference to FIG. 8 through FIG. 10, explanation is given for a second embodiment of the present invention. The present embodiment differs from the above described first embodiment that prepares a screen for setting the connection method, and explanation is given for an example in which management information registered in advance and user information that is user input are used, and a connection method and connection information in accordance with the user information are written to the IC tag. Below, differences with the above described first embodiment are mainly explained, and explanation of portions that are similar to the above described first embodiment are omitted. An overview of the communication system according to

the present embodiment is similar to FIG. 1, which is explained in the above described first embodiment. However, in the present embodiment the network **110** is a network to which only limited users have an access authority. The hardware configuration of the information processing apparatus **130** and the image forming apparatus **140** is similar to in the above described first embodiment, and so explanation thereof is omitted.

(65) <Software Configuration>

(66) With reference to FIG. 8, explanation is given for a software configuration of the communication system **100** according to the present embodiment. The information processing apparatus **130** is similar to as in the above described first embodiment, so explanation thereof is omitted.

(67) The image forming apparatus **140** comprises a communication control unit **811**, an NFC control unit **812**, a user information management unit **813**, and a user information input unit **814**. The communication control unit **811** performs communication with the communication control unit **401** via the communication control unit **307**. The NFC control unit **812** receives a notification from the user information management unit **813** and writes to the IC tag of the NFC communication unit **310** the connection method to be used in a handover and the connection information relating to the connection method. Regarding writing to the IC tag, because it is similar to in the above described first embodiment, explanation thereof is omitted.

(68) The user information input unit **814** displays on the display unit **306** a screen that prompts for user information input, and receives input of user information from the operation unit **305**. When the user information input unit **814** receives input of user information, notifies the user information management unit **813**. In the present embodiment, the user information is a user name. The user information management unit **813** has management information that links the user information and the connection method usable in handovers. The information may be stored in the RAM **303**, or may be stored in an external storage apparatus of a server or the like via a network. In the present embodiment, of the connection methods that the communication control unit **307** supports, wireless LAN and WiFi-Direct are the connection methods usable in handovers.

(69) In the present embodiment, the user information management unit **813** has the management information illustrated in FIG. 9, and it is stored in the RAM **303**. The user information management unit **813** receives the notification of the user information from the user information input unit **814**, compares it against the management information, and determines whether there is a privilege to access the network. The connection method to be used in a handover is selected in accordance with the result of this determination, and the selected connection method is notified to the NFC control unit **812**. In the present embodiment, for users having authorization to access the network **110**, the wireless LAN is selected as the connection method; for all other users, WiFi-Direct is selected.

(70) <Management Information>

(71) With reference to FIG. 9, explanation is given for an example of the management information that the user information management unit **813** has. In the present embodiment, user names and privileges to access the network **110** are linked and managed. In the example of FIG. 9, a user A has an access privilege, and the user B does not have an access privilege. Accordingly, wireless LAN is selected as the connection method for the user A, and WiFi-Direct is selected as the connection method for the user B.

(72) <Processing of the Image Forming Apparatus>

(73) Next, with reference to FIG. 10, explanation is given for a processing procedure of the user information management unit **813** of the image forming apparatus **140** according to the present embodiment. This processing is started when the user information is notified from the user information input unit **814** to the user information management unit **813**. Note that the processing explained below is realized by the system control unit **301** reading the control program stored in the ROM **302** or the external storage apparatus **309** into the RAM **203** and executing it.

(74) In step **S1001**, the user information management unit **813** compares the user name included in the user information notified from the user information input unit **814** and the user names in the management information that the user information management unit **813** manages, and a transition is made to step **S1002**. In step **S1002**, the user information management unit **813** determines whether there is an item of having the same user name as the user name that is notified in the management information, based on the result of the comparing in step **S1001**. If present, transition is made to step **S1003**; if not present, transition is made to step **S1005**. For example, in a case of the present embodiment, if the notified user name is “user A” or “user B”, it is determined that an item of the same user name is present in the management information; if the notified user name is “user C” then it is determined not to be present.

(75) In step **S1003**, the user information management unit **813** refers to information of a network access privilege that is linked to the notified user name. If the access privilege is present transition is made to step **S1004**, if not present transition is made to step **S1005**. For example, in the case of the present embodiment, if the notified user name is “user A” then it is determined that the access privilege is present, and if it is “user B” then it is determined that the access privilege is not present.

(76) In step **S1004**, the user information management unit **813** selects wireless LAN as the connection method, and transition is made to step **S1006**. In step **S1005**, the user information management unit **813** selects WiFi-Direct as the connection method, and transition is made to step **S1006**. In step **S1006**, the user information management unit **813** notifies the connection method selected in the previous step to the NFC control unit **812**, and this processing terminates.

(77) Note that, for the present embodiment, because there are two types of connection methods usable in handovers, the management information only manages the existence/absence of authorization regarding one of the connection methods, and the other connection method is used when the managed connection method cannot be used. However, the present invention is not limited to the case of two types of connection method as illustrated in the present embodiment, and the configuration of the management information and the processing of the user information management unit **813** may be appropriately changed within a scope in which the spirit of the present invention is not undermined.

(78) As explained above, according to the present embodiment, it is possible to use a connection method suitable for each user as the connection method to which to switch communication in a handover.

Third Embodiment

(79) Below, with reference to FIG. **11** through FIG. **12**, explanation is given for a third embodiment of the present invention. The present embodiment differs from the above described first and second embodiments in that the information processing apparatus **130** notifies the connection method desired to be used in handovers to the image forming apparatus **140**, and the image forming apparatus **140** writes connection information to the IC tag in accordance with the notified connection method. Below, differences with the above described first embodiment are mainly explained, and explanation of portions that are similar to the above described first embodiment are omitted. An overview of the communication system according to the present embodiment is similar to FIG. **1**, which is explained in the above described first embodiment. The hardware configurations of the information processing apparatus **130** and the image forming apparatus **140** are similar to in the above described first embodiment, and so explanation thereof is omitted.

(80) <Software Configuration>

(81) Next, with reference to FIG. **11**, explanation is given for a software configuration of the communication system **100** according to the present embodiment. The information processing apparatus **130** has an application **1100**. The application **1100** is stored in the storage **207**, and is executed by the system control unit **201** as necessary. The application **1100** comprises a communication control unit **1101**, an NFC control unit **1102**, and a connection method selection

unit **1103**. The connection method selection unit **1103** selects the connection method to use in a handover in accordance with a user input, and notifies the selected connection method to the image forming apparatus **140**.

(82) More specifically, the connection method selection unit **1103** has a list of the connection methods that can be used in the handover, and when the user instructs selection of the connection method to the application **1100**, the list is displayed on the touch screen display **208**. The list may be held in advance by the application **1100**, or may be dynamically generated by the application **1100** referring to the connection methods that the information processing apparatus **130** or the image forming apparatus **140** support. In the present embodiment, the above described list is something that the application **1100** has in advance, and wireless LAN and WiFi-Direct are included as items in the list.

(83) The connection method selection unit **1103** notifies the connection method that the user selected from the displayed connection methods to the image forming apparatus **140** via the NFC control unit **1102**. In the present embodiment, the notification of the connection method is assumed to be writing information of the connection method to a particular address of the IC tag of the NFC communication unit **310**. The NFC control unit **1102** uses the NFC communication unit **213** to perform communication with the NFC communication unit **310** of the image forming apparatus **140**. In the present embodiment, by performing communication with the NFC communication unit **310**, the NFC control unit **1102** performs notification of the connection method and obtaining of the connection information.

(84) The communication control unit **1101** performs communication, via the communication unit **202**, with a communication control unit **1111**, based on the connection information that the NFC control unit **1102** obtained. The image forming apparatus **140** comprises the communication control unit **1111** and an NFC control unit **1112**. The communication control unit **1111** performs communication with the communication control unit **1101** via the communication control unit **307**. The NFC control unit **1112** periodically refers to the NFC communication unit **310**, and confirms whether the connection method has been notified from the NFC control unit **1102**.

(85) In the present embodiment, confirmation of notification of the connection method is assumed to be confirmation as to whether there is a change to information that indicates the connection method and is written to a particular address of an IC tag of the NFC communication unit **310**. Furthermore the NFC control unit **1112** confirms whether the notified connection method can be supported by the image forming apparatus **140**, and if determined to be supportable, the connection information regarding the connection method is written to the IC tag of the NFC communication unit **310**. In the present embodiment, if the notified connection method is present among network connection methods that are supported by the communication control unit **307**, the NFC control unit **1112** determines that it can be supported.

(86) <Processing of the Image Forming Apparatus>

(87) Next, with reference to FIG. **12**, explanation is given for a processing procedure of the NFC control unit **1112** of the image forming apparatus **140** according to the present embodiment. This processing is started upon a power supply activation of the image forming apparatus **140**. During operation of the image forming apparatus **140**, this processing is continuously performed. Note that the processing explained below is realized by the system control unit **301** reading a control program stored in the ROM **302** or the external storage apparatus **309** into the RAM **203** and executing it.

(88) In step **S1201**, the NFC control unit **1112** confirms the IC tag to determine whether notification of the connection method has been performed. The processing then transitions to step **S1202**. In step **S1202**, the NFC control unit **1112** determines whether notification of the connection method has been performed. If the notification has been performed transition is made to step **S1203**; if there is no notification, transition is made to step **S1201**.

(89) In step **S1203**, the NFC control unit **1112** determines whether the image forming apparatus

140 can support the notified connection method. If it can be supported transition is made to step **S1204**; if it cannot be supported, transition is made to step **S1201**. In the present embodiment, as described in the explanation of the NFC control unit **1112** of FIG. **11**, if a connection method that the communication control unit **307** supports is notified, then it is supportable. In step **S1204**, the NFC control unit **1112** writes connection information corresponding to the connection method to the IC tag, and transition is made to step **S1201**. Regarding writing to the IC tag, because it is similar to in the above described first embodiment, explanation thereof is omitted.

(90) As explained above, according to the present embodiment, by the information processing apparatus **130** instructing a connection method to be used in the handover, it is possible to use a connection method suited to the user of the information processing apparatus **130**.

Fourth Embodiment

(91) Below, with reference to FIG. **13** through FIG. **15**, explanation is given for a fourth embodiment of the present invention. The present embodiment differs to the above described first through third embodiments, and a connection method suited to the circumstances is automatically selected from connection methods that the image forming apparatus **140** supports. More specifically, when a notification that communication has terminated is received, control is performed so as to select by default WiFi-Direct by which communication is possible even without an access privilege, and control is performed to switch the connection method when communication by another connection method is requested. Below, differences with the above described first embodiment are mainly explained, and explanation of portions that are similar to the above described first embodiment are omitted.

(92) <System Configuration>

(93) Firstly, referring to FIG. **13**, explanation is given of the communication system according to the present embodiment. Reference numeral **100** in the drawing is the communication system, which is comprised of the network **110**, the access point **120**, the information processing apparatus **130**, and the image forming apparatus **140**. Because the network **110**, the access point **120**, the information processing apparatus **130**, and the image forming apparatus **140** are similar to in the above described first embodiment, explanation thereof is omitted. A print instructing apparatus **1301** is connected via the network **110** so that it is able to communicate with the image forming apparatus **140**, and transmits print data to the image forming apparatus **140** in accordance with an operation of a user.

(94) The hardware configurations of the information processing apparatus **130** and the image forming apparatus **140** are similar to in the above described first embodiment, and so explanation thereof is omitted. However, when the communication control unit **307** in the present embodiment uses one of the supported network connection methods to perform communication, another network connection method cannot be used.

(95) <Software Configuration>

(96) Next, with reference to FIG. **14**, explanation is given for a software configuration of the communication system **100** according to the present embodiment. The information processing apparatus **130** has the application **400**. The application **400** comprises the communication control unit **401** and the NFC control unit **402**. Because the application **400**, the communication control unit **401**, and the NFC control unit **402** are similar to in the above described first embodiment, explanation thereof is omitted.

(97) The image forming apparatus **140** comprises a communication control unit **1411** and an NFC control unit **1412**. The communication control unit **1411** performs communication with the communication control unit **401** or the print instructing apparatus **1301** via the communication control unit **307**. When starting communication, the communication control unit **1411** notifies the connection method to be used to the NFC control unit **1412**. When communication terminates, the communication control unit **1411** notifies communication termination to the NFC control unit **1412**. The NFC control unit **1412** receives the notification of the connection method from the

communication control unit **1411**, selects the connection method most suited to be used in a handover, and writes the selected connection method and the connection information to the IC tag of the NFC communication unit **310**.

(98) In the present embodiment, the NFC control unit **1412** selects, from the connection methods that the communication control unit **307** supports, the connection method for no inconvenience occurs when using the connection method and furthermore has the highest possibility that the user of the information processing apparatus **130** can use it when it is used in a handover. In other words, the NFC control unit **1412** normally selects WiFi-Direct, which is capable of communication even when the user does not have a privilege to access the network **110** of the information processing apparatus **130**. Accordingly, when a simple termination of communication is received, WiFi-Direct is selected. However, only when a connection by wireless LAN is notified from the communication control unit **1411**, wireless LAN is selected to avoid interrupting wireless LAN communication for communication that is in progress currently, by using WiFi-Direct in a handover. In other words, if connection by wireless LAN is notified from the communication control unit **1411**, for example circumstances in which wireless LAN communication is currently being performing are envisioned, and maintaining that connection method is envisioned. In this way, by virtue of the present invention, the image forming apparatus **140** selects the connection method according to the current communication circumstances.

(99) <Processing of the Image Forming Apparatus>

(100) Next, with reference to FIG. **15**, explanation is given for a processing procedure of the NFC control unit **1412** of the image forming apparatus **140** according to the present embodiment. This processing is started when a notification of the connection method is received from the communication control unit **1411**. Note that the processing explained below is realized by the system control unit **301** reading a control program stored in the ROM **302** or the external storage apparatus **309** into the RAM **203** and executing it.

(101) In step **S1501**, the communication control unit **1411** determines whether the received notification is a termination of communication. If it is a communication termination, transition is made to step **S1504**; otherwise, transition is made to step **S1502**. In step **S1502**, the communication control unit **1411** determines whether the notified connection method is wireless LAN. If it is wireless LAN, transition is made to step **S1503**; otherwise, transition is made to step **S1504**. In step **S1503**, the communication control unit **1411** selects wireless LAN as the connection method, and transition is made to step **S1505**.

(102) Meanwhile, in step **S1504** the communication control unit **1411** selects WiFi-Direct as the connection method, and transition is made to step **S1505**. In step **S1505**, the communication control unit **1411** writes the connection method selected in the previous step (step **S1503** or step **S1504**) and the connection information corresponding to the connection method to the IC tag. Regarding details of the writing to the IC tag, because it is similar to in the above described first embodiment, explanation thereof is omitted.

(103) As explained above, by virtue of the present embodiment, it is possible for the information processing apparatus **130** to normally use in a handover the connection method most likely to be usable, but to use another connection method to avoid inconvenience if inconvenience occurs due to using the connection method.

Fifth Embodiment

(104) Below, with reference to FIG. **16** and FIG. **17**, explanation is given for a fifth embodiment of the present invention. The present embodiment is a variation of the above-described first through fourth embodiments, and selects a replacement connection method from usable connection methods if a connection method that the communication control unit **307** supports cannot be used for any reason. In the present embodiment, differences with the above described first embodiment are recited as a focus, and explanation of portions that are similar to the above described first embodiment are omitted. A schematic view of the communication system according to the present

embodiment is illustrated in FIG. 1, similarly to in the above described first embodiment. The hardware configurations of the information processing apparatus **130** and the image forming apparatus **140** are similar to in the above described first embodiment, and so explanation thereof is omitted.

(105) <Software Configuration>

(106) Next, with reference to FIG. 16, explanation is given for a software configuration of the communication system **100** according to the present embodiment. The information processing apparatus **130** has the application **400**. The application **400** comprises the communication control unit **401** and the NFC control unit **402**. Because the application **400**, the communication control unit **401**, and the NFC control unit **402** are similar to in the above described first embodiment, explanation thereof is omitted. The image forming apparatus **140** comprises a communication control unit **1611**, an NFC control unit **1612**, and a connection method monitoring unit **1613**.

(107) The connection method monitoring unit **1613** uses the communication control unit **307** to monitor whether the connection methods that the communication control unit **307** supports are in a usable state. More specifically, a connection state with a connector or the access point **120**, the validity/invalidity of a function in a device setting of the image forming apparatus **140**, or the like is constantly monitored. For example, if a LAN cable is detached from the connector, wired LAN is unusable, if the connection with the access point **120** is cut wireless LAN is unusable, and if WiFi-Direct becomes inactive in device settings of the image forming apparatus **140**, WiFi-Direct is unusable. If there is a change in the connection method usable state, the connection method monitoring unit **1613** notifies this to the NFC control unit **1612**. The communication control unit **1611** performs communication with the communication control unit **401** via the communication control unit **307**. The NFC control unit **1612** writes the connection method to be used in the handover and the connection information relating to the connection method to the IC tag of the NFC communication unit **310**.

(108) Upon receiving the notification from the connection method monitoring unit **1613**, the NFC control unit **1612** confirms whether the connection method selected as the connection method to be used in the handover is unusable. If it is unusable, it is displayed that the selected connection method is unusable on the display unit **306**, a suitable connection method is re-selected from the usable connection methods as necessary, and the connection method and the connection information are written to the IC tag. If no usable connection method remains, the NFC control unit **1612** deletes the connection method and the connection information from the IC tag. In the present embodiment, the two connection methods that can be used in a handover, out of connection methods that the communication control unit **307** supports, are wireless LAN and WiFi-Direct. Accordingly, in a case where either becomes unusable, the other is re-selected as the connection method if it is usable.

(109) <Processing of the Image Forming Apparatus>

(110) Next, with reference to FIG. 17, explanation is given for a processing procedure of the NFC control unit **1612** of the image forming apparatus **140** according to the present embodiment. This processing is started when notification of the usable state is received from the connection method monitoring unit **1613**. Note that the processing explained below is realized by the system control unit **301** reading the control program stored in the ROM **302** or the external storage apparatus **309** into the RAM **203** and executing it.

(111) In step **S1701**, the connection method monitoring unit **1613** determines whether it has been notified that all connection methods are unusable. If all are unusable transition is made to step **S1705**, otherwise transition is made to step **S1702**. In step **S1702**, the connection method monitoring unit **1613** confirms whether it has been notified that the selected connection method is unusable. If it is unusable, transition is made to step **S1703**; if it is usable, transition is made to step **S1707**. Note that the selected connection method is the connection method selected in the above-described the first through fourth embodiments, and differs to the connection method to be re-

selected in step S1704 which is explained later.

(112) In step S1703, the connection method monitoring unit **1613** displays on the display unit **306** to the effect that the selected connection method cannot be used. The processing then transitions to step S1704. In step S1704, the connection method monitoring unit **1613** re-selects the connection method and stores it in the ROM **302**. The connection information corresponding to the re-selected connection method is then written to the IC tag, and this processing terminates. In the present embodiment, this step is taken when, out of the wireless LAN and WiFi-Direct, one selected as the connection method becomes unusable and the other is usable. Accordingly, in this step the usable one is re-selected as the connection method, and the re-selected connection method and the connection information are written to the IC tag.

(113) In step S1705, the connection method monitoring unit **1613** displays on the display unit **306** to the effect that the selected connection method cannot be used, and transition is made to step S1706. In step S1706, because the handover cannot be performed, the connection method monitoring unit **1613** deletes the connection method and the connection information from the IC tag. Subsequently this processing terminates. Meanwhile, in step S1707, the connection method monitoring unit **1613** re-selects the connection method, writes the connection method and the connection information to the IC tag, and this processing terminates.

(114) As explained above, by virtue of the present embodiment, it is possible to use a suitable connection method to perform a handover even when a connection method of the image forming apparatus **140** cannot be used.

Other Embodiments

(115) The present invention is not limited to the embodiments described above, and various modifications are possible. For example, a case in which the image forming apparatus **140** is connected to the network **110** and the wired LAN without passing through the access point **120**, as in the communication system **1800** illustrated in FIG. **18**, can be considered. In such a case, the image forming apparatus **140** can use the wired LAN instead of the wireless LAN as the connection method used in the handover. However, even when the wired LAN is used as the connection method used in the handover, because the information processing apparatus **130** connects to the network **110** by wireless communication, it is necessary to write information of the access point **120** that is connected to the network **110** as the connection information. However, because the image forming apparatus **140** is connected to the network **110** by wire without passing through the access point **120**, it is not possible to obtain the information of the access point **120** from a network setting of the image forming apparatus **140**.

(116) Accordingly, in the present embodiment, a configuration is provided whereby, when the image forming apparatus **140** is connected to the network **110** by the wired LAN, the information of the access point used as the connection information is set in the image forming apparatus **140**. More specifically, in a case where the user has instructed, from the operation unit **305**, a setting of the access point for the handover, the image processing apparatus **130** displays an access point information input screen on the display unit **306**, and receives input of access point information from the user. When the wired LAN is used in the handover, the image forming apparatus **140** uses the access point information input from the user as the connection information. Note that the access point information input screen may be just a screen for inputting the access point, or, for example, may enable input as a part of the connection method selection as illustrated in FIG. **5** or FIG. **19**.

(117) Embodiment(s) of the present invention can also be realized by a computer of a system or apparatus that reads out and executes computer executable instructions (e.g., one or more programs) recorded on a storage medium (which may also be referred to more fully as a 'non-transitory computer-readable storage medium') to perform the functions of one or more of the above-described embodiment(s) and/or that includes one or more circuits (e.g., application specific integrated circuit (ASIC)) for performing the functions of one or more of the above-described embodiment(s), and by a method performed by the computer of the system or apparatus by, for

example, reading out and executing the computer executable instructions from the storage medium to perform the functions of one or more of the above-described embodiment(s) and/or controlling the one or more circuits to perform the functions of one or more of the above-described embodiment(s). The computer may comprise one or more processors (e.g., central processing unit (CPU), micro processing unit (MPU)) and may include a network of separate computers or separate processors to read out and execute the computer executable instructions. The computer executable instructions may be provided to the computer, for example, from a network or the storage medium. The storage medium may include, for example, one or more of a hard disk, a random-access memory (RAM), a read only memory (ROM), a storage of distributed computing systems, an optical disk (such as a compact disc (CD), digital versatile disc (DVD), or Blu-ray Disc (BD)TM), a flash memory device, a memory card, and the like.

(118) While the present invention has been described with reference to exemplary embodiments, it is to be understood that the invention is not limited to the disclosed exemplary embodiments. The scope of the following claims is to be accorded the broadest interpretation so as to encompass all such modifications and equivalent structures and functions.

(119) This application claims the benefit of Japanese Patent Application No. 2014-232939 filed on Nov. 17, 2014, which is hereby incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

Claims

1. A data communication apparatus, comprising: a wireless communicator that executes wireless communication; a user interface that receives an SSID for the wireless communication; and a controller that stores, in an NFC tag of an NFC communicator, both the SSID received by the user interface and address information of the data communication apparatus that receives the SSID by the user interface.
2. The data communication apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the user interface further receives a security key for the wireless communication.
3. The data communication apparatus according to claim 1, further comprising a display that displays a setting screen, wherein the user interface receives the SSID via the setting screen.
4. The data communication apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the user interface further receives a selection of a wireless communication mode, wherein the user interface is able to receive the SSID on a condition that a selection of a predetermined wireless communication mode is received by the user interface.
5. The data communication apparatus according to claim 4, wherein the predetermined wireless communication mode is different from a Wi-Fi Direct mode.
6. The data communication apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the controller is connected to the NFC communicator via a cable.
7. The data communication apparatus according to claim 1, further comprising a scanner that scans a document.
8. The data communication apparatus according to claim 1, further comprising a printer that prints an image.
9. The data communication apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the address information of the data communication apparatus is an IP address of the data communication apparatus.
10. The data communication apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the user interface further receives a selection of a wireless connection destination, and the user interface is able to receive the SSID on a condition that a selection of a predetermined wireless connection destination is received by the user interface.
11. A control method for controlling a data communication apparatus that comprises a wireless communicator that executes wireless communication, the control method comprising: receiving an SSID for the wireless communication; and storing, in an NFC tag of an NFC communicator, both

the received SSID and address information of the data communication apparatus that receives the SSID by the user interface.

12. A non-transitory computer readable storage medium for storing a computer program for causing a data processing apparatus to execute a control method for controlling a data communication apparatus that comprises a wireless communicator that executes wireless communication, the control method comprising: receiving an SSID for the wireless communication; and storing, in an NFC tag of an NFC communicator, both the received SSID and address information of the data communication apparatus that receives the SSID by the user interface.

13. A data communication apparatus, comprising: a wireless communicator that executes wireless communication; a user interface that receives an SSID for the wireless communication; and a controller that stores, in an NFC tag of an NFC communicator, both the SSID received by the user interface and address information of the data communication apparatus that receives the SSID by the user interface, wherein the controller further stores, in the NFC tag of the NFC communicator, an SSID of an access point to which the data communication apparatus is connected.

14. A non-transitory computer readable storage medium for storing a computer program for causing a data processing apparatus to execute a control method for controlling a data communication apparatus that comprises a wireless communicator that executes wireless communication, the control method comprising: receiving, by a user interface of the data communication apparatus, an SSID for the wireless communication; storing, in an NFC tag of an NFC communicator, both the received SSID and address information of the data communication apparatus that receives the SSID by the user interface; and storing, in the NFC tag of the NFC communicator, an SSID of an access point to which the data communication apparatus is connected.
